

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	CHC337
Subject Title	History of Medicine in China 中國醫療史
Credit Value	3
Level	3
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This course surveys the history of medicine through the study of medical theories, practices, and beliefs in China. Paying close attention to the ever-changing socio-historical and cultural contexts, this course will examine how those ideas and beliefs formed, how the practices have changed over time, and specifically how the introduction of Western science, as exemplified by scientific biomedicine, effected fundamental changes in Chinese medicine in the twentieth century. This course also introduces students to necessary research skills and methods for the study of medical history of China and is designed to facilitate them to undertake independent research. Course materials include primary texts, secondary scholarship, and visual and material artefacts.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) understand the diversity of practices in Chinese medicine as well as the competing attempts to construct philosophical and metaphysical ideas about medicine in Chinese history; b) develop an interdisciplinary approach to examining prominent topics about Chinese medicine by drawing on cultural history, anthropology, gender studies, and philosophy; c) read and analyze primary texts about Chinese medicine; d) evaluate, create, and communicate historical arguments about the important themes and topics in the Chinese medical culture and tradition; e) undertake independent research and develop critical thinking and writing skills.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1) Introduction and Framing: Contemporary Debates on Chinese Medicine 2) Early Chinese Divination, Science, and Medicine 3) Medical Canons: <i>Inner Classic of the Yellow Emperor</i> and <i>Classic of Difficult Issues</i> 4) Medical Practitioners and Healers 5) <i>Yi'an</i>: Case Studies in Imperial China 6) Gender in Chinese Medicine 7) Missionary Medicine from the West 8) Public Health and State-Building 9) Medical Institutions and Movements 10) Health Technologies and Products 11) Medicines and Ideologies 12) State Medicine for Rural China 13) Reflecting on “Traditional Chinese Medicine”
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	Drawing on cultural history, gender studies, philosophy, and anthropology, this course employs an interdisciplinary approach to examining the history of medicine in China in its ever-shifting intellectual, cultural, and socio-historical contexts. This course covers key concepts, practices, and beliefs in the Chinese medical tradition and culture. The course instructor will guide students to read, analyze primary and secondary historical texts, communicate historical arguments, and eventually to undertake independent research on the history of medicine in China. To this end, readings and assessment components are carefully selected and designed to facilitate students’ in-depth understanding of course topics, hone their public presentation skills, and equip them with critical academic writing skills and practices.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b	c	d	e	
	1. mid-term quiz	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	2. final-term quiz	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	3. oral presentation	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	4. Final essay	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	Total	100 %						
	1. The mid-term and final-term quizzes are ideal forms to directly assess and evaluate the students’ grasp of the knowledge about the ideas, practices, and beliefs in the Chinese medical tradition. They will enable the students to acquire a deeper understanding of the historical and conceptual knowledge learned from the lectures. 2. Oral presentations can best evaluate the students’ overall grasp of the knowledge and skills acquired from lectures and their own readings. It offers opportunities for students to formulate their own questions, interact with one another, and actively participate in dynamic discussions. It also lays foundation for students to undertake independent research. 3. The final essay, done in accordance with the instructor’s comments and feedback, will best assess the students’ appreciation of the information, concepts, and ideas learnt from the subject and their ability to articulate their own research findings in written forms.							
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	▪ lectures							26 Hrs.
	▪ tutorials							13 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:							
	▪ Readings							39 Hrs.
	▪ Writings							20 Hrs.
	▪ Discussions							8 Hrs.
	Total student study effort							106 Hrs.
Reading List and References	1. Andrews, Bridie. <i>The Making of Modern Chinese Medicine, 1850–1960</i>. Vancouver: University of British Columbia Press, 2014. 2. Bray, Francesca. <i>Technology, Gender and History in Imperial China: Great Transformations Reconsidered</i>. London: Routledge, 2013.							

	3. Bu Liping. <i>Public Health and the Modernization of China, 1865–2015</i>. London: Routledge, 2017. 4. Cullen, Christopher. “Yi’an (Case Statment): The Origins of a Genre of Chinese Medical Literature.” In <i>Innovation in Chinese Medicine</i>, edited by Elisabeth Hsu, 297–323. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2001. 5. Chen, C. C. <i>Medicine in Rural China: A Personal Account</i>. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1989. 6. Cochran, Sherman. <i>Chinese Medicine Men: Consumer Culture in China and Southeast Asia</i>. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 2006. 7. Fang Xiaoping. <i>Barefoot Doctors and Western Medicine in China</i>. Rochester, NY: University of Rochester Press, 2012. 8. Furth, Charlotte. <i>A Flourishing Yin: Gender in China’s Medical History, 960–1665</i>. 9. Furth, Charlotte, Judith T. Zeitlin, and Ping-chen Hsiung, eds. <i>Thinking with Cases: Specialist Knowledge in Chinese Cultural History</i>. Honolulu: University of Hawai’i Press, 2007. 10. Hinrichs, T. J. “New Geographies of Chinese Medicine.” In <i>Osiris</i>. 2nd ser., vol. 13, <i>Beyond Joseph Needham: Science, Technology, and Medicine in East and Southeast Asia</i>, edited by Morris F. Low, 287–325. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1998. 11. <i>Huang Di Nei Jing Su Wen: An Annotated Translation of Huang Di’s Inner Classic – Basic Questions: 2 Volumes</i>. Translated by Unschuld, Paul, and Hermann Tessenow. Berkeley: University of California Press, 2011. 12. Lei, Sean Hsiang-lin. <i>Neither Donkey nor Horse: Medicine in the Struggle over China’s Modernity</i>. Chicago: the University of Chicago Press, 2014. 13. Leung, Angela Ki Che and Izumi Nakayama, eds. <i>Gender, Health, and History in Modern East Asia</i>. Hong Kong: Hong Kong University Press, 2017. 14. Lo, Vivienne and Michael Stanley-Baker, with Dolly Yang, eds. <i>Routledge Handbook of Chinese Medicine</i>. London: Routledge, 2022 (multiple entries on Chinese medicine). 15. Rogaski, Ruth. <i>Hygienic Modernity: Meanings of Health and Disease in Treaty-Port China</i>. Berkeley: University of California Press, 2004. 16. Scheid, Volker. <i>Chinese Medicine in Contemporary China: Plurality and Synthesis</i>. Durham, NC: Duke University Press, 2002. 17. Sivin, Nathan. <i>Medicine, Philosophy and Religion in Ancient China: Researches and Reflections</i>. Brookfield, VT: Variorum, 1995. 18. Unschuld, Paul U. <i>Medicine in China: A History of Ideas</i>. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1985. 19. Unschuld Paul U, ed. <i>Nan Jing: The Classic of Difficult Issues</i>. Oakland, California: University of California Press, 2016.
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	20. Wu, Yi-li. <i>Reproducing Women: Medicine, Metaphor, and Childbirth in Late Imperial China</i>. Berkeley: University of California Press, 2010. 21. Yip, Ka-che. <i>Health and National Reconstruction in Nationalist China: The Development of Modern Health Services, 1928–1937</i>. Ann Arbor, MI: Association for Asian Studies, 1995.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020